

The `animation-delay` CSS property specifies the amount of time to wait from the moment an animation is applied to an element until it actually starts performing the animation. This delay is only applied before the first iteration of the animation. [MDN Web Docs +2](#)

Syntax

The basic syntax for the `animation-delay` property is: [MDN Web Docs](#)

CSS

```
animation-delay: <time>;
```

Property Values

The property accepts the following values: [W3Scho... +1](#)

- <time>**: A value in seconds (`s`) or milliseconds (`ms`) that defines the duration of the delay before the animation begins.
 - Positive values** (e.g., `2s` or `500ms`) mean the animation starts after that amount of time has elapsed.
 - `0s` (the default value) means the animation starts as soon as it is applied to the element.
 - Negative values** (e.g., `-1s`) cause the animation to begin immediately, but partway through its cycle, as if it had already been playing for that duration.
- initial**: Sets the property to its default value (0s).
- inherit**: Inherits the property from its parent element. [W3Schools +4](#)

Example

To add a 2-second delay to an animation, you would use:

CSS

```
.box {  
  animation-name: slidein;  
  animation-duration: 4s;  
  animation-delay: 2s; /* The animation will wait 2 seconds before starting */  
}  
  
@keyframes slidein {  
  from {
```

```
transform: translateX(0);  
}  
to {  
  transform: translateX(100px);  
}  
}
```

[You can find more examples and an interactive demo on the [MDN Web Docs](#) or [W3Schools](#)].

Using the Shorthand Property

`animation-delay` is often used as part of the `animation` shorthand property. When using the shorthand, the second time value specified is assigned to the `animation-delay` property:  [MDN Web Docs](#)

CSS

```
/* duration | timing-function | delay | iteration-count | direction | fill-mode | r  
animation: 4s          ease-in-out      2s          infinite          alternate for
```

[More details on the shorthand property are available on the [MDN Web Docs](#)]. 

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Syntax

Examples



W3Schools

<https://www.w3schools.com> › cssref › css3_pr_animate...

CSS animation-delay Property

The **animation-delay** property specifies a **delay** for the start of an **animation**. The **animation-delay** value is defined in seconds (s) or milliseconds (ms). [Read more](#)



CSS-Tricks

<https://css-tricks.com> › a-new-way-to-delay-keyframes...

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Tailwind CSS

<https://tailwindcss.com> › docs › transition-delay

transition-delay - Transitions & Animation

Use utilities like **delay-150** and **delay-700** to set the transition **delay** of an element in milliseconds. [Read more](#)